

Trophy

Baker's Fightback Falls Just Short

Gregg Williams's first Trophy title survived a final-round surge from Jon Baker that included his best-ever gross round, but it arrived two shots too late.

Gregg Williams took the final round of the TEG 5 Trophy at Palmares and held on for the title. He survived a stretch that ought, by any reasonable accounting, to have taken it off him. Between the 10th and the 13th he dropped ten shots. A triple bogey, then two doubles, then another triple. Four holes, no discernible plan. At the 16th he added a quintuple bogey 9, presumably to confirm that none of it had been accidental.

And yet the round left him level with his overnight cushion on net score. The gap to the field closed only from five shots to two. This is what winning looks like in this company. Not the avoidance of wreckage, simply wreckage arranged more economically than everybody else's.

The closing pressure came from Jon Baker, who shot a personal-best gross round of 90. That is four better than his previous mark on the course, and it deserves stating without qualification. It was not, however, an untroubled 90. Baker handed over five shots to par across the first four holes. At the short 5th he took a quintuple bogey 8, which on a short hole requires a certain commitment. Then came birdies at the 14th and the 15th, back to back, and with them an actual contest. It was not quite enough. Williams's overnight advantage proved just durable enough, and the Trophy went by two shots. David Mullin's overnight edge, meanwhile, kept him clear at the top of the Green Jacket race.

AT A GLANCE
Trophy Winner Gregg Williams
Green Jacket Stuart Neumann
Wooden Spoon David Mullin

Round Net VP
JB -4 HM -3 GW -1 SN +4 DM +7
Round Gross
HM +17 JB +18 DM +22 SN +24 GW +32

After R4 • Trophy
GW -6 JB -4 SN +8 HM +10 DM +12
After R4 • Green Jacket
SN +88 DM +72 JB +84 HM +90 GW +126

Henry Meller

Meller's Best Round Arrives Too Late

Henry Meller's first look at Palmares produced the best round of his TEG career, net and gross, built out of the wreckage of three horror holes in the middle of his back nine.

Henry Meller produced a personal-best round at Palmares, on TEG's first visit to the course. He finished at -3 on the net and +17 gross, his best figures on both counts. The card does not read like a personal best. Meller had gone into the day propping up the Wooden Spoon race. Holes 9 through 11 then passed without a single net par: a triple bogey at the 9th, followed by two double

bogeys, seven gross shots gone. His position at the foot of the standings looked, at that point, entirely secure. A double bogey at the 15th duly dropped him to the bottom of the Spoon outright, from third to fifth.

Then he simply stopped losing shots. The 16th and the 17th came and went without a blemish, and

the round stood as his best of the tournament by a distance. It also shunted David Mullin into last place in the Spoon instead, with the gap to safety cut from eight strokes to two. A day that had looked entirely lost, quietly converted into something else.

David Mullin

Mullin Wins Jacket, Finds The Spoon Too

David Mullin sealed another Green Jacket in the same round that left him marooned at the bottom of the Wooden Spoon table, swapping places with Henry Meller in the closing holes.

David Mullin's fourth round in the Algarve was an exercise in keeping the good news and the bad news in separate rooms. He held top spot in the Green Jacket race, extending his overall command even as the margin there narrowed from 14 strokes to 12. Everywhere else, the ground gave way. In the Trophy he fell from first place after

round one all the way to fifth. And in the Wooden Spoon, a quadruple-bogey nine at the par-5 6th sent him from fourth to bottom of the table, swapping places with Henry Meller, the gap back up to the field cut from eight strokes to two. A nine at a par 5 is not misfortune. It is a body of work.

There was recovery, of a sort. A triple bogey at the 9th, a bogey at the 10th, a double bogey at the 11th. Then he birdied the 12th, and birdied the par-5 13th as well. Two consecutive holes without dropping a gross shot. He might reasonably have expected applause. Instead the damage elsewhere caught up with him.

Records & Personal Bests

Notable achievements: TEG 5, Round 4

TEG Records

- David Mullin's 2-hole "Birdies" streak ties the all-time TEG record (2), at T05 R4 H12 to T05 R4 H13
- Jon Baker's 2-hole "Birdies" streak ties the all-time TEG record (2), at T05 R4 H14 to T05 R4 H15

Personal Bests

- Henry Meller posts a personal-best round: -3
- Henry Meller posts a personal-best Gross round: +17
- Jon Baker posts a personal-best Gross round: +18